ARIA

AI Marketing Team for Developer Founders

Product Requirements Document

Version 1.0 | March 2026

Status: Draft

Classification: Confidential

1. Executive Summary

ARIA is a cloud-hosted SaaS platform that provides developer founders with an AI-powered marketing team. Instead of traditional marketing software modules, ARIA deploys autonomous AI agents organized in a company-like hierarchy, each responsible for a specific marketing function. The platform provides both strategic guidance (what to do) and tactical execution (doing it), enabling technical founders to run professional marketing campaigns without marketing expertise.

For v1, ARIA focuses exclusively on digital marketing for developer founders who are building products but lack the knowledge, time, or budget to market them effectively. The platform guides users through GTM strategy creation and then executes against that strategy through content creation, email marketing, and social media management, with a copy-paste delivery model for channels like Facebook Ads where direct API integration is not yet available.

2. Problem Statement

2.1 The Core Problem

Developer founders are exceptional at building products but consistently fail at marketing them. They face a compounding set of challenges: they lack marketing knowledge and vocabulary, they cannot afford agencies ($2,000–$5,000/month) or full-time marketing hires, they waste time on scattered tools (ChatGPT for copy, Canva for graphics, Mailchimp for email, Buffer for social), and they have no coherent strategy connecting their marketing activities.

The result is that technically excellent products go undiscovered, and developer founders either burn out trying to learn marketing or give up and hope for organic growth that never materializes.

2.2 Why Existing Solutions Fail

Solution	Why It Fails for Dev Founders
ChatGPT / Claude	No continuity, no strategy, no business context. Every session starts from zero. Output is generic without deep product knowledge.
Jasper / Copy.ai	Content generation only. No strategy, no distribution, no campaign coordination. Just another tool in the stack.
HubSpot / Mailchimp	Assumes marketing knowledge. Powerful but overwhelming for someone who doesn't know what a drip campaign is or why they need one.
Marketing agencies	Expensive, slow feedback loops, often don't understand technical products. Minimum $2K/month for basic services.
Freelancers	Quality varies wildly, require management overhead, no strategic continuity between tasks.

2.3 Target User Persona

Name: The Technical Founder

Background: Software developer or engineer who has built a product (SaaS, developer tool, API, or app) and needs to acquire users/customers.

Marketing experience: Minimal to none. May have posted on Hacker News or Product Hunt once. Has read a few marketing blog posts but has no systematic approach.

Budget: $50–$300/month for marketing tools. Cannot justify agency fees or a marketing hire.

Time: Can dedicate 2–5 hours/week to marketing. Spends the rest building product.

Pain: Knows marketing matters, feels guilty about not doing it, doesn't know where to start, and is frustrated that existing tools assume knowledge they don't have.

3. Product Vision

3.1 One-Line Vision

ARIA is the marketing co-founder that developer founders never had — it builds your GTM strategy and then executes it for you.

3.2 Core Principles

- **Guidance before execution:** ARIA doesn't just generate content. It first understands your product, audience, and goals, builds a strategy, and then executes against that strategy. Every piece of content ties back to a plan.
- **Context and continuity:** Unlike ChatGPT, ARIA remembers your product, your brand voice, your audience, and your campaign history. It builds on previous work rather than starting from scratch.
- **Agents as employees:** Each marketing function is handled by a specialized AI agent with a defined role, organized in a hierarchy. This is intuitive and maps to how real marketing teams work.
- **Progressive disclosure:** Non-technical users see simple outputs (content ready to copy-paste). Technical users can dig into agent configurations, prompts, and workflows.
- **Copy-paste first, automation later:** For v1, ARIA produces ready-to-use outputs with step-by-step instructions for manual execution. Direct integrations come in v2+.

3.3 Agent Architecture (v1)

ARIA v1 deploys the following agent hierarchy for the marketing module:

Agent	Role	Responsibilities

ARIA_CEO	Chief Marketing Strategist	Onboards the user, builds GTM playbook, coordinates all other agents, reviews and approves outputs, adjusts strategy based on performance.
ContentWriter	Content Creation Agent	Blog posts, landing page copy, product descriptions, case studies, thought leadership pieces. Maintains brand voice consistency.
EmailMarketer	Email Campaign Agent	Welcome sequences, newsletter drafts, drip campaigns, launch announcements. Provides copy-paste-ready email content with subject lines and send timing.
SocialManager	Social Media Agent	Platform-specific posts (X/Twitter, LinkedIn, Facebook), content calendar, engagement suggestions, hashtag strategy. Adapts content from ContentWriter for each platform.
AdStrategist	Paid Ads Advisor	Facebook/Meta ad copy, audience targeting recommendations, budget allocation suggestions, A/B test variants. Provides detailed step-by-step instructions for manual ad setup.

4. Feature Specification

4.1 Onboarding & GTM Strategy Builder

Priority: P0 (Must have for launch)

Owner Agent: ARIA_CEO

The onboarding flow is the most critical feature in v1. It transforms ARIA from a generic content tool into a strategic marketing partner. The CEO agent conducts a structured intake conversation to build a comprehensive GTM playbook.

Onboarding Flow

- **Product Discovery:** What is the product? What problem does it solve? What makes it different? Who are the competitors? The agent asks conversational questions and extracts structured data.
- **Audience Definition:** Who is the ideal customer? What are their pain points? Where do they hang out online? What language do they use to describe their problems?
- **Goals & Constraints:** What does success look like (users, revenue, awareness)? What is the timeline? What is the marketing budget? How much time can the founder dedicate weekly?
- **Channel Prioritization:** Based on the audience and product type, ARIA recommends which channels to focus on and in what order (e.g., content marketing + Twitter for developer tools, LinkedIn + email for B2B SaaS).
- **Playbook Generation:** ARIA produces a written GTM playbook that includes: positioning statement, messaging pillars, content themes, channel strategy, 30/60/90 day action plan, and KPIs to track.

Output

A stored GTM Playbook document that all other agents reference when producing content. This becomes the system of record for the marketing strategy and can be revised as the founder learns what works.

4.2 Content Creation Engine

Priority: P0 (Must have for launch)

Owner Agent: ContentWriter

The ContentWriter agent produces long-form and short-form marketing content aligned to the GTM playbook. Unlike standalone AI writing tools, every piece of content is grounded in the product context, audience definition, and strategic goals established during onboarding.

Content Types (v1)

Content Type	Description	Typical Output
Blog Posts	SEO-optimized articles targeting keywords relevant to the product's audience. Includes meta descriptions, headers, and CTAs.	1,000–2,000 word article, ready for CMS
Landing Page Copy	Headline, subheadline, feature bullets, social proof sections, and CTA copy for product landing pages.	Structured copy blocks with placement notes
Product Hunt Launch Copy	Title, tagline, description, first comment, and maker comment for PH launches.	Complete PH listing ready to paste
Show HN / Indie Hackers Posts	Community-appropriate posts that tell the product story without being overtly promotional.	Post draft with community norms guidance
Email Copy	Feeds into EmailMarketer agent. Blog-to-email adaptations, standalone announcements.	Email body with subject line options

Key Differentiators

- **Brand voice consistency:** Learns and maintains the founder's tone from onboarding and refines it based on feedback.
- **Strategic alignment:** Content topics are suggested based on the GTM playbook, not generated randomly.
- **Content calendar:** ARIA maintains a publishing schedule and proactively suggests what to write next and when.

4.3 Email Marketing

Priority: P1 (Ship within 30 days of launch)

Owner Agent: EmailMarketer

The EmailMarketer agent produces complete email campaigns that the founder copies into their email tool of choice (Mailchimp, ConvertKit, Resend, etc.). ARIA does not send emails directly in v1 but provides everything needed to execute.

Campaign Types

- **Welcome Sequence:** 3–5 email series for new signups. Introduces the product, delivers value, and drives activation.
- **Launch Sequence:** Pre-launch teaser, launch day announcement, follow-up with social proof, final reminder.
- **Newsletter Template:** Weekly or biweekly newsletter format with product updates, content roundup, and community highlights.
- **Re-engagement:** Win-back emails for inactive users.

Output Format

Each email includes: subject line (with 2–3 variants for A/B testing), preview text, email body in plain text and HTML-ready format, recommended send time, and notes on segmentation if applicable.

4.4 Social Media Management

Priority: P1 (Ship within 30 days of launch)

Owner Agent: SocialManager

The SocialManager agent adapts content from the ContentWriter for platform-specific distribution and maintains a social content calendar.

Platforms (v1)

- **X / Twitter:** Threads, standalone posts, engagement replies. Optimized for developer audiences.
- **LinkedIn:** Professional posts, article summaries, company updates. Optimized for B2B.
- **Facebook:** Page posts, group-appropriate content. Primarily for ad copy support.

Output Format

Copy-paste-ready posts with character counts, hashtag suggestions, recommended posting times, and image/visual suggestions (text descriptions only in v1, not generated images).

4.5 Facebook Ads Advisor (Copy-Paste Model)

Priority: P1 (Ship within 30 days of launch)

Owner Agent: AdStrategist

This is a critical differentiator for v1. Rather than integrating with the Meta Ads API, ARIA produces detailed, step-by-step instructions that walk a developer founder through creating and managing Facebook/Meta ad campaigns. The founder follows the instructions manually in Meta Ads Manager.

What the AdStrategist Produces

- **Campaign structure recommendation:** Campaign objective, ad set organization, budget allocation across ad sets.
- **Audience targeting specs:** Detailed targeting parameters (interests, demographics, behaviors, lookalike suggestions) with exact values to enter in Ads Manager.
- **Ad creative:** Primary text (multiple variants), headline, description, CTA button selection. Ready to paste into ad creation flow.
- **Step-by-step setup guide:** Numbered instructions with screenshots descriptions (e.g., 'Click Campaign > Create > Select Conversions as your objective'). Written for someone who has never used Ads Manager.
- **Budget recommendations:** Daily/lifetime budget suggestions based on the founder's stated budget and goals.
- **A/B testing plan:** Which variables to test first, how long to run tests, what metrics to evaluate.
- **Optimization checkpoints:** Scheduled reminders (via cron jobs) to review ad performance with specific instructions on what to check and how to adjust.

Example User Flow

1. Founder tells ARIA: "I want to run Facebook ads to get signups for my developer tool. Budget is $500/month."

2. AdStrategist asks clarifying questions about target audience, landing page, and conversion goals.

3. AdStrategist produces a complete campaign plan with 2–3 ad set configurations and 3–4 ad creative variants per set.

4. Each ad creative includes the exact text to paste into each field in Meta Ads Manager.

5. Step-by-step instructions walk the founder through the entire setup process in Ads Manager.

6. After 7 days, ARIA prompts the founder to input basic performance metrics (spend, impressions, clicks, conversions) and provides optimization recommendations.

5. Data Model & System of Record

ARIA serves as the system of record for all marketing strategy and content. The following data entities are stored and maintained:

Entity	Description	Persistence
Product Profile	Product name, description, value prop, competitors, differentiators	Created at onboarding, updated by user
Audience Definition	ICP details, pain points, channels, language patterns	Created at onboarding, refined over time
GTM Playbook	Positioning, messaging pillars, channel strategy, 30/60/90 plan	Generated by CEO agent, versioned
Brand Voice	Tone descriptors, example phrases, do/don't guidelines	Learned during onboarding, refined via feedback
Content Calendar	Scheduled content pieces with status, type, channel, publish date	Maintained by agents, editable by user
Content Library	All generated content with metadata, performance notes, versions	Append-only, searchable
Campaign History	Ad campaigns, email campaigns with structure and copy	Append-only, referenced for optimization
Performance Log	User-reported metrics (clicks, signups, open rates, ad spend)	Manual input by user, used for strategy adjustment

6. Technical Architecture

6.1 Platform

- **Deployment:** Cloud-hosted SaaS
- **AI Backend:** Claude API (Anthropic) as primary model provider. Agent orchestration managed by ARIA's internal runtime.
- **Agent Framework:** Hierarchical agent system with CEO agent delegating to specialized agents. Agents share context through the stored product profile and GTM playbook.

- **Integrations (v1):** MCP connectors for future integrations. v1 is copy-paste output only.
- **Cron Jobs:** Scheduled agent tasks for content calendar reminders, optimization checkpoints, and performance review prompts.

6.2 Integration Roadmap

Phase	Integrations	Timeline
v1 (Launch)	None — copy-paste model with step-by-step instructions	Launch
v1.5	Email service providers (ConvertKit, Mailchimp) via MCP	Launch + 60 days
v2	Social media publishing (X/Twitter, LinkedIn) via MCP	Launch + 120 days
v2.5	Meta Ads API integration for automated campaign management	Launch + 180 days
v3	Analytics ingestion (Google Analytics, Plausible) for automated performance tracking	Launch + 270 days

7. User Experience

7.1 First-Time User Journey

1. Signup: Developer founder creates account. Minimal friction — email + password or GitHub OAuth.

2. Onboarding conversation: ARIA_CEO agent initiates a guided conversation (10–15 minutes) to understand the product, audience, goals, and constraints.

3. GTM Playbook delivery: ARIA generates and presents a GTM playbook. User reviews, provides feedback, and approves or requests revisions.

4. First content: ContentWriter agent produces the first piece of content (blog post or landing page copy) based on the playbook. User reviews and provides feedback on voice/tone.

5. Campaign setup: User selects a campaign type (e.g., Facebook Ads for signups). AdStrategist produces the full plan with copy-paste instructions.

6. Ongoing: ARIA maintains the content calendar, prompts the user on schedule, and adjusts strategy based on reported performance.

7.2 Interface Model

The primary interface is conversational (chat-based), consistent with the existing ARIA UI. Users interact with agents through the chat pane, with the org chart providing a visual overview of their marketing team. Key UI elements include:

- **Chat pane:** Primary interaction surface. User messages are routed to the appropriate agent by the CEO agent.

- **Org chart:** Visual representation of the agent hierarchy. Click an agent to see its recent work, status, and outputs.
- **Content library:** Searchable archive of all generated content, organized by type and campaign.
- **Content calendar:** Visual timeline of planned and published content across channels.
- **Playbook view:** Dedicated view for the GTM strategy document, always accessible and editable.

8. Pricing Strategy

Pricing is positioned to be significantly cheaper than a marketing agency or freelancer, while more expensive than standalone AI tools to reflect the strategic value.

Tier	Price	Includes
Starter	$49/month	GTM playbook, 10 content pieces/month, content calendar, 1 campaign plan/month
Growth	$149/month	Everything in Starter + 30 content pieces/month, email sequences, social calendar, 3 campaign plans/month, optimization reviews
Scale	$299/month	Everything in Growth + unlimited content, priority generation, custom agent configurations, dedicated support

Note: Pricing does not include the founder's own ad spend on platforms like Meta. ARIA provides the strategy and creative; the founder manages their own ad budgets directly in the ad platforms.

9. Success Metrics

9.1 Product Metrics

Metric	Target (90 days post-launch)	Why It Matters
Onboarding completion rate	>70% of signups complete onboarding	If users don't finish onboarding, the product can't deliver value
Content adoption rate	>50% of generated content is used (copied/published)	Measures whether outputs are actually useful
Weekly active users	>40% of paying users active weekly	Indicates ongoing value, not one-time curiosity
Retention (Month 2)	>60% of Month 1 paid users retain	Core product-market fit signal

NPS	>40	Overall satisfaction and word-of-mouth potential

9.2 Business Metrics

Metric	Target (90 days)	Notes
Paying users	200+	Indicates willingness to pay for the value prop
MRR	$15,000+	Sustainable if growth continues; covers infrastructure costs
CAC	<$50	Achievable via organic channels (content, communities, build-in-public)
LTV:CAC ratio	>3:1	Healthy unit economics for reinvestment

10. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
Strategy quality is poor — GTM playbooks are generic or wrong	High	Encode real marketing expertise into agent system prompts. Hire marketing advisors to review playbook templates. Dogfood with 10 beta founders.
Copy-paste model is too much friction	Medium	Prioritize integration roadmap based on user feedback. Track where users drop off in the manual execution flow.
Content sounds AI-generated and generic	High	Invest heavily in brand voice learning during onboarding. Use the product profile and audience data to ground every output. Allow user feedback loops.
Developer founders won't pay for marketing tools	Medium	Validate pricing with beta users. Offer a free tier or trial with limited content generation. Show ROI through performance tracking.
Competitive pressure from ChatGPT, Jasper, etc.	Medium	Differentiate on strategy + context + continuity. Competitors are tools; ARIA is a team. Marketing positioning should emphasize this.
API costs erode margins at lower price tiers	Medium	Monitor per-user API costs closely. Use Claude Sonnet for routine content, reserve Opus for strategy and complex tasks. Set generation limits per tier.

11. Roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Focus

Alpha	Month 1–2	Onboarding flow + GTM playbook generation + content creation engine. Test with 10–15 beta founders.
v1 Launch	Month 3	Full marketing module: onboarding, content, email, social, ad advisor. Copy-paste model. Public launch.
v1.5	Month 5	Email provider integrations (MCP). Performance analytics input. Playbook refinement based on reported metrics.
v2	Month 7	Social publishing integrations. Analytics ingestion. Multi-channel campaign coordination.
v2.5	Month 9	Meta Ads API integration. Automated campaign management. Budget optimization.
v3	Month 12+	Expand beyond marketing module. CRM/sales agent, customer support agent. ERP vision begins.

12. Open Questions

- **Agent model selection:** Which tasks use Claude Opus vs. Sonnet? Need to balance quality against API costs and latency.
- **Performance data input:** How do users report marketing metrics back to ARIA? Manual input via chat? CSV upload? Screenshot parsing?
- **Multi-user support:** Will v1 support teams (founder + a co-founder or VA), or is it single-user only?
- **Image generation:** Social posts and ads need visuals. Does v1 include AI image generation, or is it text-only with visual suggestions?
- **Competitive positioning:** How aggressively do we position against existing tools (Jasper, HubSpot) vs. positioning as a new category?
- **Onboarding length:** 10–15 minutes may be too long for some users. Need to test whether a shorter onboarding with progressive profiling works better.

Appendix A: Competitive Landscape

Competitor	Category	ARIA Differentiation
ChatGPT / Claude (direct)	General AI assistant	No business context, no strategy, no continuity. ARIA is purpose-built for marketing with persistent product knowledge.
Jasper	AI content platform	Content only, no strategy. No agent hierarchy or campaign coordination. $49–$125/month.
Copy.ai	AI copywriting	Similar to Jasper. Workflow automation is generic, not marketing-specific.

HubSpot	Marketing suite	Powerful but complex and expensive. Assumes marketing knowledge. Free CRM, but marketing hub starts at $800+/month.
Buffer / Hootsuite	Social media management	Scheduling only, no content creation or strategy. No cross-channel coordination.
Marketing agencies	Service provider	Expensive ($2K–$10K/month), slow, often don't understand technical products.